

Jiacheng (Karcen) Zheng

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary fields	Health Economics; Econometrics; Behavioral Economics; Regional Economics; Poverty
Methods	Causal Inference; Data Science in Economics; Machine Learning / NLP; Network and Input–Output Analysis
Additional interests	fMRI

EDUCATION

Tianjin University

Sep 2026–Jun 2029 (expected)

MPhil in Applied Economics, Ma Yinchu School of Economics

Advisor: Asst. Prof. Shenshen Yang. Research themes include theoretical econometrics, causal inference, missing data, and public health policy.

Shandong University

Sep 2022–Jun 2026

B.Eng. in Bioengineering, Marine College

GPA: 86.24/100; rank: 5/50 (top 10%); **Excellent Graduate**. Dual-degree program track in *International Politics & International Economics and Trade*, School of Northeast Asian Studies (2022–2023).

Undergraduate thesis: *Is More Complexity Always Better? Hepatotoxicity Prediction of Marine Natural Products with in vivo Validation in Danio rerio* — ranked #1 in the defense panel.

Dalian University of Technology

Sep 2019–Mar 2021

Undergraduate Study in Chemical Engineering, School of Chemistry

GPA: 88/100; top 7.4% of the cohort. Withdrew in 2021 and retook the National College Entrance Examination (Gaokao).

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles and Conference Papers

1. You, P., Chen, A., Feng, Q., Hou, J., **Zheng, J.**, & Chen, H. “Integrative Bioinformatics Prioritizes the TLR4 Axis and Candidate Non-Starch Polysaccharides in Hyperuricemia-Associated Inflammation.” *Biology*, **15**, 1150, 2026. doi:10.3390/biology15141150
2. Chen, B., Hong, D., Ji, J., **Zheng, J.**, Dong, B., Zhou, J., Wang, K., Dai, J., Wang, X., Chen, W., Zheng, Q., Li, W., Han, S., Guo, Y., & Yang, Y. “InterMT: Multi-Turn Interleaved Preference Alignment with Human Feedback.” *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2025)*, **Spotlight**. Project page
3. Khan, J., **Zheng, J.**, Ahmad, M., & Khan, Z. A. “Agglomeration economies and inequality: theory and evidence from provincial China.” *Journal of Chinese Economic and Business Studies*, **24**(2), 317–340, 2026. doi:10.1080/14765284.2025.2538328

Translation and Acknowledged Scholarly Contributions

- Crescenzi, R., & Rodríguez-Pose, A. *Innovation and Regional Growth in the European Union* (Chinese edition; translated by Jianhui Ren et al.). Beijing Economic Management Press, 2024. Contributed the translation of **Chapter 3, “Geographical Accessibility and Human Capital Accumulation.”** The book received the Third Prize of the “Hundred Works” Project for Outstanding Achievements in Social Sci-

ence Research in Shanxi Province.

- Khan, J., Li, Y., & Mahsud, Q. J. “Linkages and Structural Changes in the Chinese Financial Sector, 1996–2018: A Network and Input–Output Approach.” *Structural Change and Economic Dynamics*, **70**, 33–44, 2024. doi:10.1016/j.strueco.2023.12.017. Acknowledged for data analysis and visualizations.
- Li, Y., & Khan, J. *Wind from the East: How Does the Belt and Road Initiative Connect Continents to Unleash Economic Potential?* Peter Lang. doi:10.3726/b22199. Acknowledged.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Tianjin University

Sep 2025–Present

Research Assistant, Ma Yinchu School of Economics & College of Management and Economics
Research in health economics and financial economics under two NSFC-funded projects.

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST)

Feb–May 2025

Research Intern, Big Data Institute of HKUST & Hong Kong Generative AI Research and Development Center

Limited (Remote)

Conducted data-science-driven preference-alignment research for multi-turn, multi-modal large language models. Collaborated with Jiaming Ji, Boyuan Chen, and other Peking University researchers on work accepted as a *NeurIPS 2025 Spotlight*.

University College London (UCL)

Jul–Aug 2024

Research Assistant, The Bartlett School of Sustainable Construction (Remote)

PI: Prof. Zhifu Mi. Contributed to reference-citation network analysis of IPCC Assessment Reports (Working Group II, AR6), including reference-database construction and analytical toolchains.

Shandong University

Mar 2023–Mar 2025

Research Assistant, Regional and Country-Specific Data Analytics Center, Institute of International Studies

PI: Prof. Yuan Li & Dr. Jamal Khan (currently Associate Professor). Helped build the center’s data infrastructure; supported programming, data visualisation, and academic writing; and worked on input–output analysis, global value chains, and ML/DL/NLP methods for data-driven economic modelling.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

31st International Input–Output Association Conference, Malé

2025[†]

Oral presentation: “Linkages and Structural Changes in the Chinese Financial Sector, 1996–2018.”

10th International Workshop on RUSE in China, Peking University

2023

Oral presentation: “Agglomeration Economies and Regional Inequality in Provincial China.”

[†]Presentation withdrawn for health reasons.

SELECTED HONORS AND AWARDS

Excellent Graduate, Shandong University

2026

National Encouragement Scholarship, Ministry of Education, P.R. China

2025

National Encouragement Scholarship, Ministry of Education, P.R. China

2023

National Scholarship, Ministry of Education, P.R. China

2020

SELECTED ACADEMIC DISTINCTIONS

Competitive graduate pre-selection / pre-admission: Peking University (Institute of New Structural Economics); Xiamen University WISE; Renmin University of China (School of Applied Economics); Shanghai University of Finance and Economics (School of Economics); Tianjin University (Ma Yinchu School of Economics).

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS**Referee:** *Journal of Chinese Economic and Business Studies*

- Chinese Economic Association UK/Europe (CEA), Communications Officer, 2026–Present
- International Input–Output Association (IIOA), member, 2025–2026
- Chinese Society of Optimization, Systems Engineering & Economic Mathematics, member, 2023–2024
- Beijing Society of Image and Graphics, member, 2023–2024

TEACHING, OUTREACH, AND SELECTED LEADERSHIP**Tian Village University Social Practice Project**

2024–Present

Community Leader on Secondment

Led after-school tutoring and popular-science outreach for rural primary and middle-school students; supported public first-aid training (CPR and Heimlich manoeuvre) and public-health awareness campaigns.

Teach for China (Bilibili)

2023

Volunteer Teacher

Recorded popular-science course videos for primary and middle-school students in less-developed regions to support educational equity.

Vice President, “Shanghai” Political Observation Club, School of Marxism, Shandong University 2024–2025

Head of External Relations, “Shanghai” Political Observation Club, School of Marxism, Shandong University 2023–2024

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming	Python; R; Stata; MATLAB; SPSS; Orange 3
Research tools	Git / GitHub; L ^A T _E X; Microsoft Office; Adobe Creative Suite
Languages	Chinese (native); English (IELTS 7.0, 2021)

References available upon request.

Last updated: September 1, 2026